

The Missing Page

The Firefly File

Junior Detectives / Ages 8-11

Case 01: The Untitled Ending

The final page has disappeared from the Idea Lab archive. A note remains: Four clues. Four words. Find the sentence and I will return the page.

How to play

Keep this free casebook beside the game. Read the exhibits, solve four clues, and collect four code words. Enter the recovered sentence in clue order to open the final page.

Every answer needed for this free case is in these pages. No purchase and no outside research are required.

The answers are all in Exhibit A. For the number pattern, use the rule printed beside the lamp. A trace tells you who was nearby; it does not, by itself, tell you why.

Ages are suggested reading trails. Readers can choose the trail that suits them. Reading with a parent or another reader is welcome.

The mystery framing and case notes are fictional game material. Quoted story excerpts retain their story context.

Pip and the Lantern Library

A new children's story by DEAN + DON SOL, written for this game.

PIP AND THE LANTERN LIBRARY

Chapter One: The Page That Lost Its Place

Nia found the library because a firefly knocked on her window.

Not a real firefly. This one had brass feet, tiny glass wings, and a light in his tummy. When he landed, he left a little gold dust on the windowsill.

"I'm Pip," he said. "We have a very small emergency."

"How small?"

"One page."

"How big an emergency?"

"That depends on the page."

Nia put on her shoes. Pip led her to a narrow house between the bakery and the bicycle shop. A lantern swung over its door. Inside, the bookshelves leaned toward one another as if they were telling secrets.

Mr Wren, the librarian, stood behind a desk. His coat was gray. Nia had blue ink on the cuff of her own jacket because she had drawn a map that morning. Pip still had gold dust on his wings.

"Welcome," said Mr Wren. "The last page of our library map has gone missing."

"Was it stolen?" Nia asked.

"We know it isn't in its usual place," he said. "Those are different things."

On the desk lay two books. One had a red star on its cover. That was the book of sky pictures. The other had a blue star. That was the book Nia needed to borrow: the library map.

She picked up the book with the blue star. The first page showed a staircase, a round window, and a room called Lost and Found. The final page, the one that showed the way into that room, was gone.

Pip leaned over her shoulder. "A mystery with a map. Excellent."

"A mystery without enough map," Nia said.

Mr Wren opened his lending book. "I had twelve books on this trolley this morning. Four have been borrowed. None have come back yet."

Nia counted the books still on the trolley to make sure the lending book was right. A detective, she decided, could be polite and still check.

Above the staircase was a narrow slit in the wall. Mr Wren was too tall to squeeze through it. So was Nia. Pip was small enough, but he hadn't tried yet.

Beside the slit, a little lamp flashed.

Twice.

Then four times.

Then eight times.

A note below it said: EACH GROUP HAS TWICE AS MANY FLASHES AS THE GROUP BEFORE.

"How many will the next group have?" Pip asked.

Nia held up her fingers, ran out of fingers, and borrowed a pencil.

Pip laughed so hard that a little gold dust drifted onto the desk.

At the back of the room stood a machine called the Index. It sorted the library's cards. Every card needed a title. Cards without titles went into a drawer marked ZERO, for Mr Wren to examine later.

The machine made a soft clack. A drawer closed.

"Was that the noise you heard when the page went missing?" Nia asked.

"The same sort of noise," Mr Wren said. "That doesn't tell us what was in the drawer."

Nia wrote that down.

Pip flew toward the narrow slit. A breeze caught him sideways. His wing brushed the wood, leaving gold dust on its edge.

"I'm all right!" he called. "And there's a passage in here!"

Nia could see only a small light moving through the wall. Then a piece of paper slid out beneath a little door by the stairs.

It wasn't the missing map page. It was a note.

DO NOT CALL A PAGE LOST UNTIL YOU HAVE LOOKED WHERE IT WAS FILED.

Nia looked at the Index.

Then at the narrow slit.

Then at the dust.

"Now," she said, "we have somewhere to start."

Pip's light blinked once in agreement.

And the library, which had been very quiet, seemed to lean closer.

Your detective notebook

Return to the game to check your answers. The game supplies a code word for each solved clue.

1. The right book

Exhibit A - the two books on the desk

What color is the star on the book Nia needs to borrow?

Answer: _____

Recovered word: _____

2. The trolley count

Exhibit A - Mr Wren's lending book

Mr Wren started with twelve books. Four were borrowed and none returned. How many remain?

Answer: _____

Recovered word: _____

Your detective notebook / continued

3. The flashing lamp

Exhibit A - the note beside the slit

The lamp flashes 2, then 4, then 8 times. Following its printed rule, how many flashes come next?

Answer: _____

Recovered word: _____

4. The gold trace

Exhibit A - the narrow slit

Which helper leaves gold dust on the edge of the narrow slit?

Answer: _____

Recovered word: _____

The final sentence

Place the four recovered words in clue order, then enter the sentence in the game.

Continue the story

These openings are an invitation to keep reading. The free case ends completely when you recover the page.

Credits

Stories and studio: Kevin Dean Rosenkrans / DEAN + DON SOL. Mystery design and original children's pilot: Don Sol with Dean. Casebook edition 1.0, October 2, 2026.